

Checklist:

Meetings Checklist

1. Define the outcome

- ☐ I know the primary purpose of this meeting.
- ☐ The meeting is mainly for one of these:
 - ☐ Making a decision
 - ☐ Sharing information
 - ☐ Providing feedback
 - ☐ Generating ideas
 - ☐ Strengthening relationships
- ☐ I can clearly state what success looks like by the end.

2. Match the format to the purpose

- ☐ The structure of the meeting fits its goal.
- ☐ I am not trying to make one meeting do too many things.
- ☐ I will redirect off-topic discussion and park unrelated issues.

3. Invite the right people

- ☐ Everyone necessary is invited.
- ☐ No one extraneous is invited.
- ☐ The people affected by the decision or discussion are represented.
- ☐ The attendee list supports useful discussion, not passive observation.

4. Help people come prepared

- ☐ The agenda is sent in advance.
- ☐ Pre-reads or slides are shared in advance when needed.
- ☐ Participants have enough context to contribute thoughtfully.
- ☐ I have planned how follow-ups and next steps will be captured.

5. Make participation safe and easy

- ☐ I will explicitly encourage questions, dissent, and honest input.
- ☐ I will set norms for respectful discussion.
- ☐ I will use a format that helps quieter people contribute.
- ☐ I will avoid letting only the loudest voices dominate.

6. Manage airtime

- ☐ I will watch for interruptions.
- ☐ I will make space for people who have not spoken.
- ☐ I will use directed questions when helpful.
- ☐ I will limit overtalking politely but firmly.

7. Close with clarity

- ☐ We will summarize decisions, feedback, or ideas before ending.
- ☐ We will agree on next steps.
- ☐ Each action item has an owner.
- ☐ Each action item has a timeline or next check-in.

Purpose-specific checks

Decision meeting

- ☐ A clear decision-maker is designated.
- ☐ Credible options are presented objectively.
- ☐ Relevant background information is included.
- ☐ The team recommendation is clear, if there is one.
- ☐ Dissenting views will get fair airtime.
- ☐ People affected by the decision will feel the process was fair.

Information-sharing meeting

- ☐ The information is worth sharing live rather than by email/chat.
- ☐ The content is clear and memorable.
- ☐ The presentation is engaging.
- ☐ The audience should leave having learned something valuable.

Feedback meeting

- ☐ The purpose is to improve work in progress, not to judge it.
- ☐ Success criteria are clear.
- ☐ Current status, concerns, and changes are presented honestly.
- ☐ Specific questions are framed to get useful feedback.
- ☐ Next steps and future milestones are clear.

Idea-generation meeting

- ☐ People have quiet time to think before or during discussion.
- ☐ The format collects ideas from everyone, not just the loudest.
- ☐ The discussion helps ideas build on each other.
- ☐ The meeting ends with a path to action.

Relationship-building meeting

- ☐ The meeting is designed to build trust and understanding.
- ☐ It encourages openness and authenticity.
- ☐ People should leave feeling cared for and more connected.

Final gut-check

- ☐ This meeting is a good use of people's time.
- ☐ Attendees will likely leave with:
 - ☐ New knowledge
 - ☐ Clearer next steps
 - ☐ A sense of engagement
 - ☐ A feeling of being welcomed
- ☐ This meeting truly needs to happen.
- ☐ I personally need to be there.